JAMES HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with seven years of hands-on experience building and maintaining large-scale backend systems. I've spent the last few years focused on infrastructure reliability and helping junior engineers grow into stronger technical leads. I'm particularly interested in problems around distributed systems and database performance, and I've led several migration projects that significantly reduced our operational costs. Outside of the technical side, I enjoy mentoring and have helped establish engineering standards across multiple teams.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

CloudScale Systems Ltd

cloudscale.io

London, United Kingdom

February 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a microservices migration strategy that reduced latency by 40% across our primary user-facing services. Led a team of five engineers through the transition while maintaining zero customer-facing downtime during the six-month project. Established internal deployment standards and created comprehensive runbooks that decreased time-to-resolution for incidents by 55%. Mentored three junior engineers, two of whom were promoted to mid-level positions within eighteen months.

Senior Engineer

Meridian Data Solutions

meridian-data.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

June 2019 - January 2022

Optimized our PostgreSQL infrastructure to handle three times the query volume, eliminating the need for costly database server additions. Built an internal observability platform using Prometheus and Grafana that became the standard monitoring solution across twelve teams. Collaborated with the security team to implement automated compliance checks in our CI/CD pipeline, reducing manual audit work by 70%. Took on-call responsibilities and improved our mean-time-to-resolution from 45 minutes to 12 minutes through better alerting and runbook automation.

Software Engineer

TechVenture Solutions Ltd

techventure.net

Liverpool, United Kingdom

September 2017 - May 2019

Developed core payment processing features handling over 2 million daily transactions with 99.98% uptime. Refactored legacy Python monolith code into maintainable modules, reducing technical debt and improving test coverage from 45% to 82%. Implemented caching strategies using Redis that improved API response times from 800ms to 150ms for common queries. Participated in on-call rotation and debugged production issues across the

full technology stack.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Liverpool

Liverpool, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, SQL, Java, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform

DevOps and Tools: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, Git

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, CloudWatch

Specializations: Microservices Architecture, Database Optimization, Infrastructure Reliability, System Design